

describing an application

feature-focus

user-focus

use case

user story

allows you to write these
requirements in **everyday language**
a **typical user** of this app should be
able to read and **understand these**
descriptions



Use Case

Title (goal we are looking for)

Actor (person who wants that goal satisfied)

Scenario (series of steps needed to accomplish the goal)



describes a **complete encounter** between the actor and our system



Use Case

Title



a short phrase with
an active verb

add new member
send mail

purchase items in cart
create note

⋮



Use Case

Title: Purchase items in cart

Actor



identifies who is
having this interaction

user

customer

member

administrator

computer system

service

external entity



Use Case

Title: Purchase items in cart

Actor: Customer

Scenario:

Customer opens shopping cart. Customer provides payment information. System validates order and provides order number to the Customer. System sends payment confirmation and order number to Customer by e-mail.



Use Case

Title: Purchase items in cart

Actor: Customer

Scenario:

- 1- Customer opens shopping cart.
- 2- Customer provides payment information.
- 3- System validates order.
- 4- System provides order number to the Customer.
- 5- System sends payment confirmation and order number to Customer by e-mail.



Use Case

Title: Purchase items in cart

Actor: Customer

Scenario:

Extension: Item is out-of-stock

Extension: Credit card declined

you can add
extensions to
your scenario



Use Case

Title: Purchase items in cart

Actor: Customer

Scenario:.....

Extension: Item is out-of-stock

Extension: Credit card declined

Pre-Condition: Customer added at least one item to the shopping cart

most of the time
you're good to
go after this



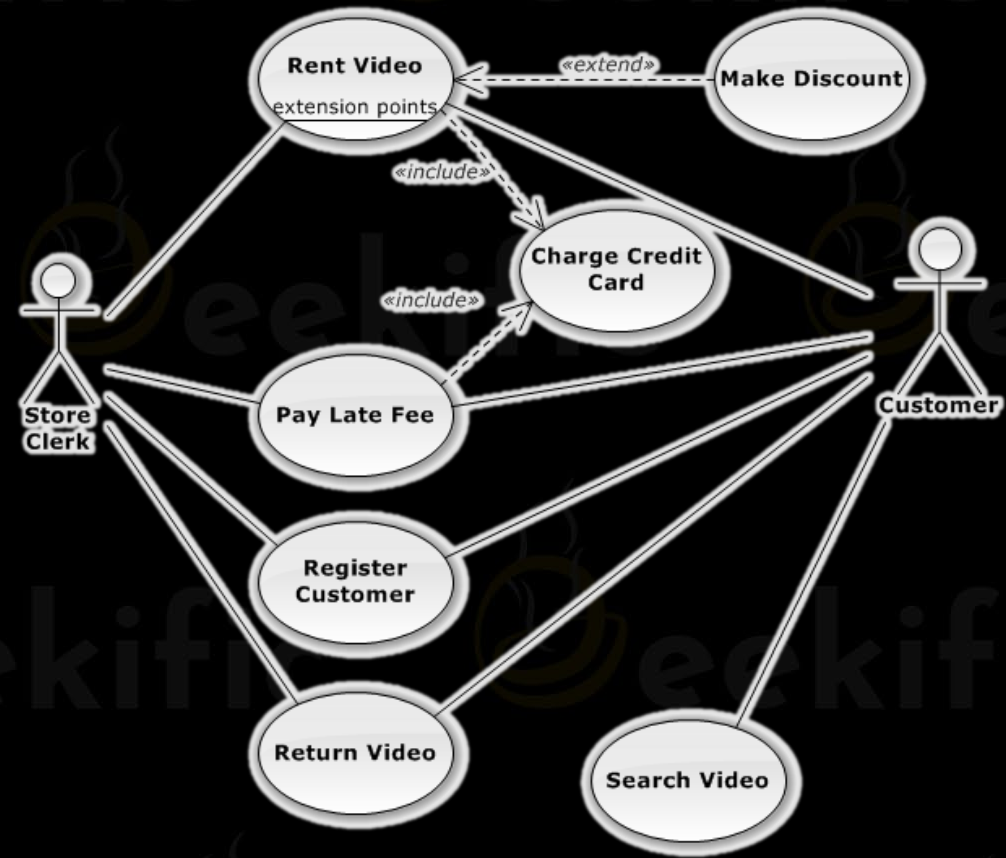
Title
Scope
Level
Primary Actor
Secondary Actors
Stakeholders
Preconditions
Postconditions
Scenario
Extensions
Special Requirements
Frequency of Occurrence
Miscellaneous
...

Fully Dressed Use Case



Use Case Diagrams

are here to support
written use-cases and
not replace them



Actors



is anything with behavior who lives
outside of your system, but has a goal
they want to accomplish within

sometimes coming up with the actor is straightforward
sometimes you might need a few minutes brainstorming it
start by separating human and non-human interactions



Actors

Primary
Actors

Secondary
Actors

the one who
initiated this
use-case

in the example we previously had,
the primary actor is the Customer

anyone else is a secondary actor



Scenario



describes a goal that an actor can accomplish in a single encounter

log in to application



user-focused



why are they trying to login?

logging in might be part of another use-case

to purchase items?
to check their account balance?



Scenario

when writing a scenario, you want to
focus on the true goal of the user

but if necessary you also need to describe
the alternate paths or extensions

do not try to lay out all possible events,
just typical situations that could occur



Scenario

when writing, use active voice, omit
needless words, omit needless details

focus on the intention, the user interface
will follow the function of our application

ask yourself a few questions that will help you
reveal a couple obvious actors for your application



Scenario

~~the system is provided with the payments information by the customer~~

customer provides payment information

avoid UI terms: page, click, button, select

~~click the checkout button~~

do we have role-based actors?

who is the administrator?

what happens if the system fails?

is anyone monitoring the system or storing logs?



User Story



simpler, shorter than a use-case
and describes a single scenario
from a user's perspective



unlike a use-case which could be extended to
several pages, a user story is typically written
as just one or two sentences



User Story

As a (user or role)

I want (a particular goal)

So that (benefit from the goal)



User Story

As a User

I want to be able to sort the entries by date

So that I can find the most recent content



User Story

focus on the intent and what
we're doing is express one need

a very quick readable summary of what a
specific goal is and why the user wants it

it can be tempting to regard a user story as a
shorter use-case but that would be a mistake



Use Case vs User Story

can be regarded as a record
of a conversation that
already happened

the more formal unified
process methodology
you'd use

a reminder that we need to
get deeper into the details
of something

should be expected if
you're working in a
SCRUM environment

a user story is not just a shorter use-case – they are very different things

